

Artemy Kolchinsky

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Last updated: February 12, 2026

- EDUCATION** **Indiana University** (Bloomington, IN, USA), 2015
Ph.D. in Informatics (focus in Complex Systems), Minor in Cognitive Science
Thesis: “Measuring Scales: Integration and Modularity in Complex Systems”
Committee: Luis M. Rocha (chair), Yong-Yeol Ahn, Randall Beer, Alessandro Flammini, Olaf Sporns
New York University (New York, NY, USA), 2004
B.A. Magna Cum Laude, Individualized Study (concentration in Complex Systems)
- ACADEMIC POSITIONS** 6/2023–Present **Universitat Pompeu Fabra** (Barcelona, Spain)
Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellow (Host: Ricard Solé)
1/2022–5/2023 **University of Tokyo** (Tokyo, Japan)
Project Researcher at the Universal Biology Institute (Research supervisor: Sosuke Ito)
12/2015–7/2021 **Santa Fe Institute** (Santa Fe, NM, USA)
Program Postdoctoral Fellow (Research supervisor: David H. Wolpert)
9/2009–8/2010 **Instituto Gulbenkian de Ciencia** (Oeiras, Portugal)
Predoctoral Visiting Researcher (Research supervisor: Luis M. Rocha)
- INDUSTRY** Summer 2014 **LinkedIn Corporation** (Mountain View, CA, USA)
Data science internship
- PUBLICATIONS** *Equal contribution †Corresponding author
- M. Aguilera^{*†}, S. Ito, **A. Kolchinsky**^{*†}, “Inferring entropy production in many-body systems using nonequilibrium MaxEnt”, *Physical Review Letters*, in press. [arXiv:2505.10444](https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.10444)
- J. Piñero, D. R. Sowinski, G. Ghoshal, A. Frank, **A. Kolchinsky**[†], “Information bounds production in replicator systems”, *Communications Physics*, in press. [arXiv:2501.00396](https://arxiv.org/abs/2501.00396)
- G.-H. Xu, **A. Kolchinsky**, J.-C. Delvenne, S. Ito, “Thermodynamic geometric constraint on the spectrum of Markov rate matrices”, *Physical Review Letters*, 135, 257102 (2025). [pdf link](#) (*Editors’ Suggestion*)
- J. Piñero*, **A. Kolchinsky***, S. Redner, R. Solé, “Neutral theory of cooperative dynamics”, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 122, 51 (2025). [pdf link](#)
- OoLEN collaboration*, “What it takes to solve the Origin(s) of Life: An integrated review. Part 1-Experimental methods and data repositories”, *Cell Reports Physical Science*, in press.
- OoLEN collaboration*, “What it takes to solve the Origin(s) of Life: An integrated review. Part 2-Theoretical methods and emerging trends”, *Cell Reports Physical Science*, in press.
- A. Kolchinsky**, “Thermodynamics of Darwinian evolution in molecular replicators”, *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B* 380,20240436 (2025). [pdf link](#)
- K. R. Thomsen, **A. Kolchinsky**, S. Rasmussen, “Protocellular energy transduction, information, and fitness”, *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B* 380, 20240294 (2025). [pdf link](#)
- S. Bartlett, A. W. Eckford, M. Egbert, M. Lingam, **A. Kolchinsky**[†], A. Frank[†], G. Ghoshal[†], “The Physics of Life: Exploring Information as a Distinctive Feature of Living Systems”, *PRX Life* 3, 037003 (2025). [pdf link](#)
- R. Nagayama, K. Yoshimura, **A. Kolchinsky**, S. Ito, “Geometric thermodynamics of reaction-diffusion systems: Thermodynamic trade-off relations and optimal transport for pattern formation”, *Physical Review Research* 7, 033011 (2025). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**[†], I. Marvian, C. Gokler, Z. Liu, P. Shor, O. Shtanko, K. Thompson, D. Wolpert, S. Lloyd, “Maximizing free energy gain”, *Entropy* 27, 91 (2025). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky, “Thermodynamic dissipation does not bound replicator growth and decay rates”, *The Journal of Chemical Physics* 161, 124101 (2024). [pdf link](#) (2024 JCP Emerging Investigators Special Collection)

R. Solé, C. P. Kempes, B. Corominas-Murtra, M. De Domenico, **A. Kolchinsky**, M. Lachmann, E. Libby, S. Saavedra, E., D. Wolpert, “Fundamental constraints to the logic of living systems”, *Royal Society Interface Focus* 14, 20240010 (2024). [pdf link](#)

P.M. Riechers, C. Gupta, **A. Kolchinsky**, M. Gu, “Thermodynamically ideal quantum state inputs to any device”, *PRX Quantum* 5, 030318 (2024). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky, “Partial information decomposition: redundancy as information bottleneck”, *Entropy* 26(7), 546 (2024). [pdf link](#)

J. Piñero, R. Solé, **A. Kolchinsky**[†], “Optimization of nonequilibrium free energy harvesting illustrated on bacteriorhodopsin”, *Physical Review Research* 6, 013275 (2024). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†], N. Ohga, S. Ito, “Thermodynamic bound on spectral perturbations, with applications to oscillations and relaxation dynamics”, *Physical Review Research* 6, 013082 (2024). [pdf link](#)

D.R. Sowinski, J. Carroll-Nellenback, R.N. Markwick, J. Piñero, M. Gleiser, **A. Kolchinsky**, G. Ghoshal, A. Frank, “Semantic Information in a model of resource gathering agents”, *PRX Life* 1, 023003 (2023). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†], “Generalized Zurek’s bound on the cost of an individual classical or quantum computation”, *Physical Review E* 108, 034101 (2023). [pdf link](#)

M. Aguilera and **A. Kolchinsky**, “Quantifying higher-order entropy production in organized nonequilibrium states”, *Proceedings of the ALIFE 2023*, 45 (2023). [pdf link](#)

N. Ohga, S. Ito, **A. Kolchinsky**, “Thermodynamic bound on the asymmetry of cross-correlations”, *Physical Review Letters* 131, 077101 (2023). [pdf link](#) (Editors’ Suggestion; Featured in *Physics*)

K. Yoshimura, **A. Kolchinsky**, A. Dechant, S. Ito, “Housekeeping and excess entropy production for general nonlinear dynamics”, *Physical Review Research* 5, 013017 (2023). [pdf link](#)

F.C. Sheldon, **A. Kolchinsky**, F. Caravelli, “Computational capacity of LRC, memristive, and hybrid reservoirs”, *Physical Review E* 106, 045310 (2022). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky, “A novel approach to the partial information decomposition”, *Entropy* 24(3), 403 (2022). [pdf code link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†] and D.H. Wolpert, “Dependence of integrated, instantaneous, and fluctuating entropy production on the initial state in quantum and classical processes”, *Physical Review E* 104, 054107 (2021). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†] and D.H. Wolpert, “Work, entropy production, and thermodynamics of information under protocol constraints”, *Physical Review X* 11, 041024 (2021). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†] and D.H. Wolpert, “Entropy production given constraints on the energy functions”, *Physical Review E* 104, 034129 (2021). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky and D.H. Wolpert, “Thermodynamic costs of Turing machines”, *Physical Review Research* 2, 033312 (2020). [pdf link](#)

D.H. Wolpert and **A. Kolchinsky**, “The thermodynamics of computing with circuits”, *New Journal of Physics* 22, 063047 (2020). [pdf link](#)

A. Kolchinsky and B. Corominas-Murtra, “Decomposing information into copying versus transformation”, *Royal Society Interface* 17, 20190623 (2020). [pdf link](#)

A.M. Saxe, Y. Bansal, J. Dapello, M. Advani, **A. Kolchinsky**, B.D. Tracey, D.D. Cox, “On the information bottleneck theory of deep learning”, *Journal of Statistical Mechanics*, 124020 (2019). [pdf code link](#)

A. Kolchinsky[†], B.D. Tracey, D.H. Wolpert, “Nonlinear information bottleneck”, *Entropy* 21(12), 1181 (2019). (Entropy 2021 Best Paper Award) [pdf code link](#)

A. Berdahl, C. Brelsford, C. De Bacco, M. Dumas, V. Ferdinand, J.A. Grochow, L. Hébert-Dufresne, Y. Kallus, C.P. Kempes, **A. Kolchinsky**, D. B. Larremore, E. Libby, E.A. Power, C.A. Stern, B.D. Tracey, “Dynamics of beneficial epidemics”, *Scientific Reports* 9, 15093 (2019). [pdf link](#)

E.A. Hobson, V. Ferdinand, **A. Kolchinsky**, J. Garland, “Rethinking animal social complexity measures with the help of complex systems concepts”, *Animal Behaviour* 155, 287-296 (2019). [pdf link](#)

- A. Kolchinsky**[†], B.D. Tracey, S. Van Kuyk, “Caveats for information bottleneck in deterministic scenarios”, *ICLR* (2019). [pdf code link](#)
- D.H. Wolpert, **A. Kolchinsky**, J.A. Owen, “A space–time tradeoff for implementing a function with master equation dynamics”, *Nature Communications* 10, 1727 (2019). [pdf link](#)
- A. Avena-Koenigsberger, X. Yan, **A. Kolchinsky**, M. van den Heuvel, P. Hagmann, O. Sporns, “A spectrum of routing strategies for brain networks”, *PLoS Computational Biology* 15(3): e1006833 (2019). [pdf link](#)
- J.A. Owen, **A. Kolchinsky**, D.H. Wolpert, “Number of hidden states needed to physically implement a given conditional distribution”, *New Journal of Physics* 21, 013022 (2019). [pdf link](#) ([correction](#))
- A. Kolchinsky**[†] and D.H. Wolpert, “Semantic information, autonomous agency, and nonequilibrium statistical physics”, *Royal Society Interface Focus* 8, 20180041 (2018). [pdf code link](#)
- A.M. Saxe, Y. Bansal, J. Dapello, M. Advani, **A. Kolchinsky**, B.D. Tracey, D.D. Cox, “On the information bottleneck theory of deep learning”, *ICLR* (2018). [pdf code link](#) (conference version)
- A. Kolchinsky**, N. Dhande, K. Park, Y.Y. Ahn, “The Minor Fall, the Major Lift: Inferring emotional valence of musical chords through lyrics”, *Royal Society Open Science* 4, 170952 (2017). [pdf data code link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**[†], D.H. Wolpert, “Dependence of dissipation on the initial distribution over states”, *Journal of Statistical Mechanics*, 083202 (2017). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**, B.D. Tracey, “Estimating mixture entropy with pairwise distances”, *Entropy* 19(7), 361 (2017). ([correction](#)) [pdf code link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**[†], A.J. Gates, L.M. Rocha, “Modularity and the spread of perturbations in complex dynamical systems,” *Physical Review E* 92, 060801(R) (2015). [pdf code link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**, A. Lourenço, H. Wu, L. Li, L.M. Rocha, “Extraction of pharmacokinetic evidence of drug-drug interactions from the literature,” *PLOS One* 10(5): e0122199 (2015). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**, M.P. van den Heuvel, A. Griffo, P. Hagmann, L.M. Rocha, O. Sporns, J. Goñi, “Multi-scale integration and predictability in resting state brain activity,” *Frontiers in Neuroinformatics* 8, 66 (2014). [pdf link](#)
- A. Rossi, F.J. Parada, **A. Kolchinsky**, A. Puce, “Neural correlates of apparent motion perception of impoverished facial stimuli I: A comparison of ERP and ERSP activity,” *NeuroImage* 98, 442-459 (2014). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**, A. Lourenço, L. Li, L.M. Rocha, “Evaluation of linear classifiers on articles containing pharmacokinetic evidence of drug-drug interactions,” *Proc Pacific Symposium on Biocomputing*, 409-420 (2013). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky** and L.M. Rocha, “Prediction and modularity in dynamical systems,” *Proc of European Conf. on the Synthesis and Simulation of Living Systems (ECAL)*, 65 (2011). [pdf link](#)
- A. Kolchinsky**, A. Abi-Haidar, J. Kaur, A.A. Hamed, L.M. Rocha, “Classification of protein-protein interaction full-text documents using text and citation network features,” *IEEE/ACM Transactions on Computational Biology and Bioinformatics* 7(3), 400-411 (2010). [pdf link](#)

PREPRINTS

- L. Greenspan, D. Berman, A. Brill, R. Jefferson, **A. Kolchinsky**, J. Lin, A. Mack, A. Maiti, F. E. Rosas, A. Stapleton, L. Teixeira, D. Vaintrob, “Towards Worst-Case Guarantees with Scale-Aware Interpretability”, [arXiv:2602.05184](#) (2026).
- A. Kolchinsky**, “Comment on ‘Dissipation bounds the coherence of stochastic limit cycles’”, [arXiv:2510.14101](#) (2025).
- J. Bauermann, G. Bartolucci, **A. Kolchinsky**, “Spatiotemporal organization of chemical oscillators via phase separation”, [arXiv:2507.16030](#) (2025).
- A. Kolchinsky**[†], A. Dechant, K. Yoshimura, S. Ito, “Generalized free energy and excess/housekeeping decomposition in nonequilibrium systems: from large deviations to thermodynamic speed limits”, [arXiv:2412.08432](#) (2025).
- A. Kolchinsky**[†], A. Dechant, K. Yoshimura, S. Ito, “Information geometry of excess and housekeeping entropy production”, [arXiv:2206.14599](#) (2022).
- C. Gokler, **A. Kolchinsky**, Z. Liu, I. Marvian, P. Shor, O. Shtanko, K. Thompson, D. Wolpert, S. Lloyd, “When

is a bit worth much more than $kT \ln 2$?", [arXiv:1705.09598](https://arxiv.org/abs/1705.09598) (2017).

INVITED TALKS

11/2025 *Kyoto Workshop on Quantum Thermodynamics & Stochastic Thermodynamics*, Kyoto University, Japan
 10/2025 *Autocatalysis in Reaction Networks Seminar (ARN)* (online)
 9/2025 *ILIAD2: ODYSSEY, conference on mathematical alignment*, Berkeley, CA, USA
 6/2025 *CRC Colloquium*, Free University of Berlin, Berlin, Germany
 5/2025 *Joint European Thermodynamics Conference*, Belgrade, Serbia
 11/2024 *Universal Biology Institute Seminar Series*, University of Tokyo, Japan
 9/2024 *Information in Matter Colloquium*, AMOLF, Amsterdam, Netherlands
 7/2024 *Physics Department Seminar*, University of Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain
 2/2024 *Seminar*, Barcelona Collaboratorium for Modelling and Predictive Biology, Barcelona, Spain
 11/2023 *Mini-workshop: Non-equilibrium thermodynamics and biology*, Biofiska Institute, Bilbao, Spain
 11/2023 *Seminar*, Basque Center for Applied Mathematics, Bilbao, Spain
 7/2023 *Information Engines at the Frontiers of Nanoscale Thermodynamics*, Telluride, CO, USA
 6/2023 *Webinar: Mathematics, Physics & Machine Learning*, Instituto Superior Técnico, Lisbon, Portugal
 6/2023 *Conference: Decomposing Multivariate Information in Complex Systems*
 Max Planck Institute for the Physics of Complex Systems, Dresden, Germany
 9/2022 *Seminar*, Dutch Institute of Emergent Phenomena, University of Amsterdam, Netherlands
 8/2022 *Seminar*, Earth-Life Science Institute (ELSI), Tokyo, Japan
 6/2022 *Evolution of complexity from the statistical physics perspective*, Yerevan Physics Institute, Armenia
 6/2022 *Yagami Statistical Physics Seminar*, Keio University, Japan
 5/2022 *Workshop on Stochastic Thermodynamics III*, University of Tokyo, Japan
 4/2022 *Cross Labs Workshop: Is AI Extending the Mind?*, Cross Labs, Japan
 2/2022 *Physics Department Colloquium Series*, University of Rochester, NY, USA
 12/2021 *Universal Biology Institute Seminar Series*, University of Tokyo, Japan
 2/2021 *Workshop: Origins of Life: The Possible and the Actual*, Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
 7/2020 *ICTP Seminar Series*, Abdus Salam International Center for Theoretical Physics, Trieste, Italy
 5/2020 *Workshop on Stochastic Thermodynamics I*, Complexity Science Hub, Vienna, Austria
 2/2020 *AI Seminar Series*, Information Sciences Institute, Los Angeles, CA, USA
 7/2019 *ISTI Seminar Series*, Los Alamos National Lab, Los Alamos, NM, USA
 6/2018 *Connectomics Lecture Series*, Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile
 4/2018 *Meeting of the Society for the Neural Control of Movement*, Santa Fe, NM, USA
 11/2017 Seoul National University, South Korea
 8/2017 *Workshop: Thermodynamics & Computation: Towards a New Synthesis*, Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
 10/2016 *Statistical Physics, Information Processing and Biology*, Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
 2/2016 Information Sciences Institute, Los Angeles, CA, USA

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

2022 Marie Curie Individual Fellowship (HORIZON-MSCA-2021-PF-01, #101068029)
 “NETOLIFE: Nonequilibrium thermodynamics of the origin of life”

GRANTS

2023 John Templeton Foundation (#62828), \$947,926, Co-PI
 “Goal-directed behavior and the origin of life”
 2022 John Templeton Foundation (#62417), \$627,227, Co-PI
 “Information architectures that enable life: the emergence of meaning”
 2019 Foundational Questions Institute (FQXi-RFP-IPW-1912), \$118,100, Co-investigator (PI: David H. Wolpert)
 “The role of constraints in the thermodynamics of intelligence”

- 2016 Foundational Questions Institute (FQXi-RFP-1622), \$128,319, Co-investigator (PI: David H. Wolpert)
“Observers as self-maintaining non-equilibrium systems”
- 2016 NSF INSPIRE (CHE-1648973), \$999,947, Co-investigator (PI: David H. Wolpert)
“Tradeoffs in the thermodynamics of computation: a new paradigm for biological information-processing”
- 2016 NSF (1620462), \$770,000, Co-investigator (PI: David H. Wolpert)
“Information Networks and the Evolution of Social Organizations”

**POPULAR
SCIENCE &
OUTREACH**

Articles

A. Kolchinsky, “The cost of sending a bit across a living cell”, *Physics Magazine*, 2023. [link](#)

Public talks

4/2018 *SITE Santa Fe* (contemporary art museum), Santa Fe, NM, USA
Public talk on “Life, entropy, and the 2nd law of thermodynamics”

TEACHING

Online courses

2018 “Fundamentals of machine learning” (w/ B.D. Tracey), Santa Fe Institute *Complexity Explorer*
Designed and delivered a 12-part online course on basics of machine learning ([link](#))

Workshops, lectures, and tutorials

- 6/2019 Santa Fe Institute Complex Systems Summer School, NM, USA
Two-part lecture series on machine learning and its research frontiers
- 3/2019 Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
Tutorial on “Machine learning with TensorFlow”
- 6/2017, Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
- 6/2018 Tutorial on introduction to programming and data analysis in Python (w/ V. Ferdinand)
- 11/2017 Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea
Week-long workshop organized w/ V. Ferdinand
“Thermodynamics, evolution, and inference through the lens of information theory”
- 11/2017 ACTioN/Trustee Meeting, Santa Fe Institute, NM, USA
Lecture on “Machine learning: A guide for the perplexed” (w/ B. D. Tracey)
- 5/2010 Instituto Gulbenkian de Ciência, Oeiras, Portugal
Assisted with week-long “Bayesian brain” educational module

Teaching Assistant at Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

- Spring 2014 “I400 Large-scale Social Phenomena” with Simon DeDeo ([link](#))
- Spring 2011 “I201 Math and logic foundations of Informatics” with Erik Wennstrom
- Fall 2010 “I485 Biologically Inspired Computing” ([link](#)) with Luis M. Rocha
Developed and implemented a 5-part problem set for a computational lab
- Fall 2008– “I210 Information Infrastructure” (various instructors)
- Spring 2009 Ran lab to assist with Python programming course

ADVISING

PhD dissertation committees

2025 *André Gomes*, PhD, Electrical & Computer Engineering, Instituto Superior Técnico, Lisbon, Portugal
Thesis: “Advances in Partial Information Decomposition”

Undergraduate projects supervised

- 2018 *Nicolas Freitas*, Santa Fe Institute Summer REU Program, Santa Fe, NM, USA
Project: “Scaling of information in biochemical systems”
- 2017 *Francis Cavanna*, Santa Fe Institute Summer REU Program, Santa Fe, NM, USA
Project: “Investigating the relationship between criticality and Landauer costs using the Ising model”

**ACADEMIC
SERVICE**

Reviewer

General: *PNAS, Nature Communications, npj Complexity, Interface Focus*
Physics: *PRL, PRX, PRX Quantum, PRR, PRE, NJP, Frontiers in Physics, J of Physics A, Physica A, EPL*
Biology: *Proc R Soc B, Phil Trans B, PLoS Comp Bio, Theory in the Biosciences, BioSystems*
Information theory and machine learning: *Entropy, ICLR, IEEE TPAMI, Kybernetika, Applied Sciences*

Guest editor

Entropy special issue on “Thermodynamics and Information Theory of Living Systems” [link](#)

Grant Review Panels

- European Research Council, Starting and Advanced Grant Panels
- Interdisciplinary Assessment Board for Artificial Intelligence, Spanish Research Agency
- John Templeton Foundation
- Swiss National Science Foundation

Conference Organization

- 12/2025 Kyoto Workshop on Quantum Thermodynamics and Stochastic Thermodynamics, co-organizer
Kyoto University, Japan ([program](#))
- 10/2024 Theoretical and Experimental Approaches to Goal-Directed Behavior, co-organizer
Basque Center for Applied Mathematics, Bilbao, Spain ([press](#))
- 7/2024 Information-Driven States of Matter, co-organizer
University of Rochester, NY, USA ([program](#)) [press](#)

Seminar Organization

- 2023– Co-organized ongoing “Complex Systems Lab” seminar series
[Barcelona Collaboratorium for Modelling and Predictive Biology](#), Barcelona, Spain
- 2008– Organized a weekly discussion group on complexity and cognitive science ([link](#))
- 2013 Indiana University, Bloomington, IN, USA

LANGUAGES Fluent: English, Russian, Spanish. Basic: Portuguese